

## WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE LOST?

## Looking for Belonging Without Knowing Where Home Is

The lost do not always know they are lost, because they do not know there is somewhere they belong.



## BIG IDEA

Lost people may be moral, religious, confident, and unaware. They live apart from the God for whom they were made.

## KEY SCRIPTURE

Ephesians 2:12-13, 19

GOSPEL NARRATIVE

Luke 15:1-32

## MEMORY VERSE

LUKE 19:10

"For the Son of man is come to seek and to save that which was lost."

## MAIN QUESTION

Can Someone Feel at Home and Still Be Lost?

45 MINUTES

## S

## SESSION SNAPSHOT



## A

## OPENING ACTIVITY: "WHERE DO I BELONG?"

## 1

## BUILD A BELONGING MAP (3 MIN)

Write WHERE DO PEOPLE BELONG? in the center. Invite answers: family, friends, teams, church, school, online groups, interests, achievements, and identities.

## 2

## HONOR THE REAL DESIRE (2 MIN)

Do not criticize the answers. Say: These forms of belonging can be real gifts. The question is whether any of them can finally tell us who we are and what life is for.

## 3

## PRESS BENEATH THE FEELING (2 MIN)

Ask: Can someone feel at home while moving away from the place he truly belongs? Would he know he was lost if everyone around him traveled the same direction?

## 4

## OPEN THE STORY (1 MIN)

Say: Jesus told three connected stories about things and people who were lost. Each story shows a different side of what lost means - and what God does.

## SESSION GOALS

Students should leave understanding:

- Lost does not mean unusually evil.
- Lostness may feel normal and comfortable.
- Lost does not mean worthless; Jesus knows and seeks the lost.
- Religious nearness is not the same as belonging to Christ.
- Jesus came to seek, save, and bring the lost home to God.



## LEADER POSTURE

Do not ask students to identify publicly as saved or lost. Let the text name lostness; give students room for honest thought and a private path to conversation.



## PREPARE

- Bible
- Board or large paper
- Markers
- Student handouts
- Private-conversation plan

Lost is not a label for unusually bad people. It describes life away from home with God.

## WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO BE LOST?

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## B CORE TEACHING

## 1 EVERYONE LOOKS FOR BELONGING

Gen. 1:26-27

The desire to belong is not foolish. Human life was made for identity, relationship, and fellowship with its Creator. Smaller communities can be gifts, but none can replace God.

EMPHASIZE: The ache points beyond the group to the Giver.

## 2 LOSTNESS OFTEN FEELS NORMAL

Luke 15:11-17

The younger son chose the far country. The older son remained nearby yet did not understand his father's heart. A person can be moral, religious, successful, or confident while living apart from God.

EMPHASIZE: Feeling at home does not prove we are home.

## 3 LOST DOES NOT MEAN WORTHLESS

Luke 15:1-10

The sheep and coin retain value while lost. They are known, sought, recovered, and celebrated. Lostness names broken place and relationship; it does not erase human dignity.

EMPHASIZE: Jesus does not seek the lost because they are worthless.

## 4 JESUS CAME TO BRING US HOME

Eph. 2:12-19

Christ does more than improve life in the far country. He seeks and saves the lost, brings those far off near, and makes strangers members of God's household.

EMPHASIZE: The Gospel brings us home to God in Christ.

## L LUKE 15: FOUR WINDOWS

SHEEP

wandering and helplessness

COIN

value while out of place

YOUNGER SON

chosen estrangement

OLDER SON

nearness without knowing the father

"was dead, and is alive again; he was lost, and is found."

## ? DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

## 1 Where do teenagers most often look for belonging?

Follow-up: Which of those can be good without being enough?

## 2 Why might a lost person not feel lost?

Follow-up: What can make life away from God feel normal?

## 3 What does each person or object in Luke 15 add?

Follow-up: Which picture challenges you most?

## 4 How can someone stay near Christian things without knowing God?

Follow-up: What warning does the older son give?

## 5 What does Jesus do that the lost cannot do for themselves?

Follow-up: Trace seek, save, bring near, and make family.

## ! WEEKLY REFLECTION

Notice each place this week where you seek the answer to: WHERE DO I BELONG?

- What promised to give you identity?
- Did it point you toward God or try to replace Him?
- Bring one observation back next week.

## + PRIVATE CONVERSATION

If this lesson made you wonder whether you belong to Christ, you do not have to answer publicly or pretend certainty. Speak privately with one of us. We will listen and open the Bible with you.

## N LEADER NOTES

- Listen before answering.
- Do not force a profession.
- Do not reassure automatically.
- Return to Christ and Scripture.
- Arrange follow-up when needed.

Jesus came to seek the lost and bring them home to God.